

SPORTSWEEK

Almonte Gazette columnist

Silver says

By Charlie Kitts



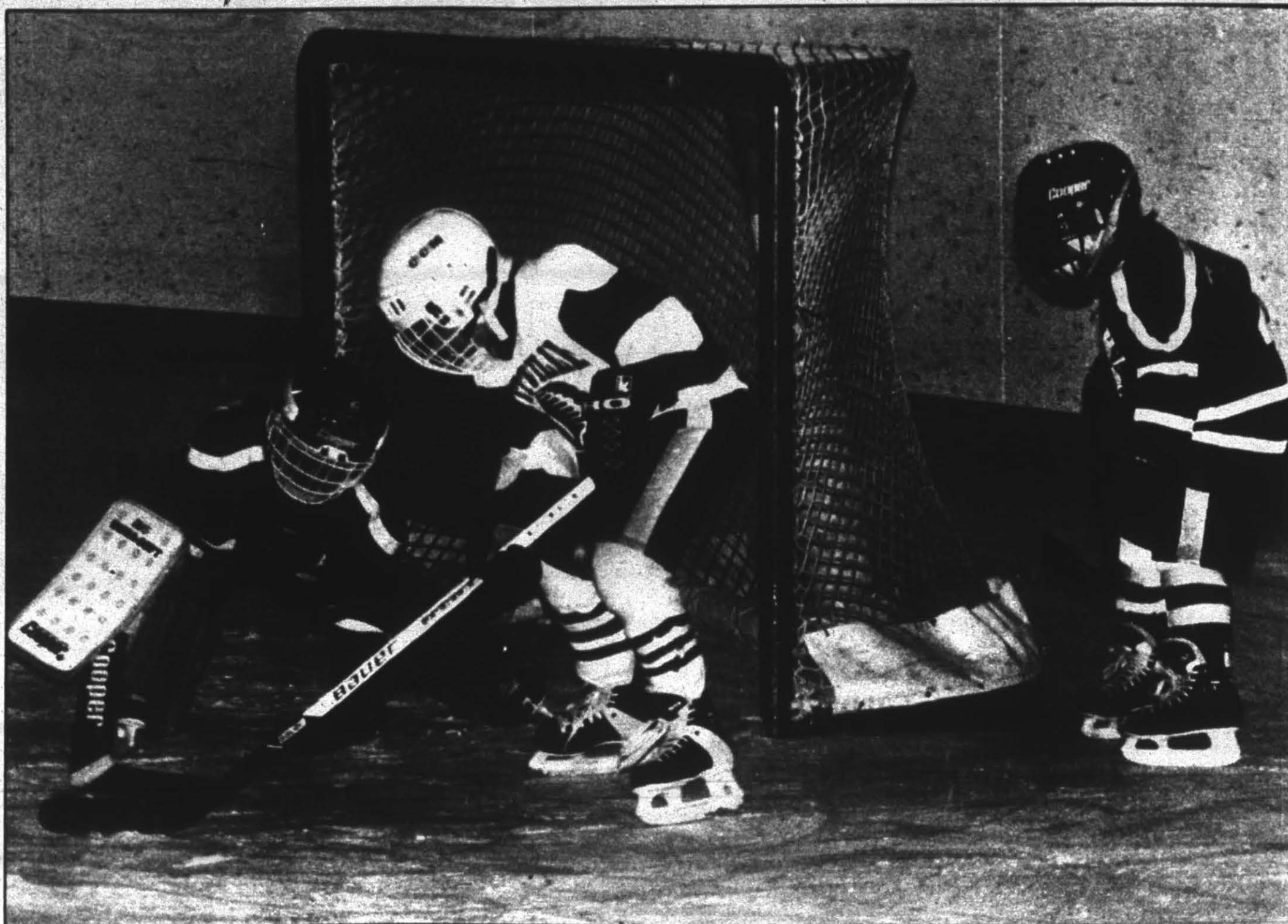
1st 14th Annual... Rod Meritthew is not getting the cooperation he wants from the weatherman...this is the 14th year for his **Big Brothers/Big Sisters** ice fishing derby...as usual anglers will try their luck on Clayton Lake...the problem as of Sunday was surface water...Rod reports five to eight inches of ice underneath...it's safe to walk out but can be a bit treacherous...it is not safe for vehicles at this time...thus the 1st 14th annual...if these conditions continue a 2nd 14th annual will be held later in the season...entry fee is \$2 children, \$5 adults, \$10 family...one prize, the biggest fish, will take half the pot...the balance goes to charity...good luck, Rod...results next week.

Experience counts... the annual Christmas Junior-Senior Triathlon hosted by Mr. and Mrs. Bango was another successful "sporting" event...participants compete in euchre, darts and pool...six two-man teams are entered...three "seniors" and three "juniors"...once again the experience, abilities and charm of the seniors propelled them to victory finishing first, second and third...in first place Garry Dalgity and Mike McAuliffe, second was a tie, Dan Hourigan and Deb Barr with Des Houston and Silver...tied next were Steve Dalgity and Bob Houston with Dan Hickey and Kevin Lee...host Jack Hudson and partner Shawn Barr finished somewhere down the list...Dan Hickey was voted rookie of the year and Des Houston was the "all round" athlete...the protest by the junior squad based on the fact the seniors all remembered the brothers Rooney and their emporium was disallowed...to top the day off Diane's food was superb — as usual...thanks folks, for a great day!

Big winner... the 1996 Ontario champion broomball team from the Naismith Pub held its annual fundraising raffle on the weekend...this year's winner of four tickets to a Senators' home game is Trevor Robertson...Phil Byrne won the Pike's YIC certificate and Lorne Ames the Naismith Pub certificate...the team, under the leadership of George Brown visits the large Syracuse International tourney this week...the 24-team event attracts teams from New York City, Toronto, the Quebec area and many other U.S. and Canadian centres...last year's entry made it to the semis facing some very tough opposition.

Na, na, na, na... we all sang the Na na song as the 'Muricans took the loss from our Canadian lads on the weekend...I doubt that we will see front page coverage in Sports Illustrated...or for that matter any coverage...perhaps they will dig into their creative bag of tricks...Canada is not really "the" world champs...no, that title should be given to the winner of a three-on-three matchup probably played in Boondoggle, Mississippi some Saturday morning...to be filmed for live, reconstructed, tape-delayed presentation on ESPN at a date to be announced...if and only if our 'Murican big brothers win...it was a good series with our junior lads improving as the games went on...the late Harold Ballard was right on in his belief Canadians (not Canadiens, Les) are the best!

She cared... she always wanted to know the entire story, who the nicknames represented, who was involved...a bit like Joe Friday, she wanted "the facts" just "the facts"...sports, politics, community events — she took them all in stride...she had the inquiring mind we hear so much about...she approached each challenge without prejudice...and, most of all she cared!...best wishes to Lois Tuffin in her new role!



Almonte-Pakenham Major Myte goalie Mark Devlin tries to cover up the puck as a Stittsville Redmen opponent attempts to jam it home during tournament action at the Almonte Arena

Friday afternoon. Defenceman Mike Hubert keeps a close watch on the action at right. The eight-team fun tournament attracted entries from around the region.

CAPs pee wee teams tie in Dec. 11 game

The Kings' Castle saw a rousing game of hockey Wednesday, Dec. 11 as the CAPs (Carleton Place-Almonte-Pakenham) pee wee A1 and A2 teams tangled in a bruising game that, surprisingly enough, was a fairly clean game with only a few penalties being assessed.

For the first period-and-a-half CAPs 1 dominated the play and by the end of the second period had scored three goals to the CAPs 2 two. Only stellar work by Garret Killam in the CAPs 2 net kept the game close.

About halfway through the middle period CAPs 2 began to roll and carried the play from then on getting goals from Stef McLean with assists going to Andrew Orchard and Andrew Smallwood. The second goal came from Jordan Purcell, unassisted.

CAPs 2 continued to dominate the play in the third period with McLean getting her second goal of the game from a scramble around the net and tying the game.

This was a tough hard-hitting game with both teams using the body and with numerous good hits in the corners and along the boards that had the fans in a constant uproar. These two teams are evenly matched and we should see some more fine hockey from both of them. In the end, the game ended in a tie.

Lanark beats CAPs A2 squad

On Monday, Dec. 16 the CAPs (Carleton Place-Almonte-Pakenham) pee wee A2 team took a trip up to Lanark and came home on the short end of a 7-2 score.

Lanark, although short on bench strength, makes up for it on hustle and know-how backed up by great goaltending.

In the first period Lanark got on the board first with the CAPs Stef McLean in the 'Sin Bin'. CAPs made it up a few minutes later with an excellent effort from the line of Bourne, Breuton and McLaughlin, Trevor Bourne drove it home while Breuton and McLaughlin were awarded well deserved assists.

Lanark kept pressing and scored its second and third goals before the period ended, with the third being a rather dubious one.

The second and third period belonged to Lanark and the team scored twice in each to put the game away. However, in both periods the CAPs sharpshooters had some good chances but were robbed by the Lanark goalie. McLean let two shots go from point blank range and came up empty-handed both times.

CAPs did manage a second goal when McLean was given credit for a tip-in on a good combination play from Andre Lamonde to Andrew Orchard on right wing who then fired a bullet at the Lanark goalie.

The team tried hard and showed a lot of heart against a very good hockey team.

Season starts well for Cottontails midget AA girls' basketball team

By Ken O'Keefe

The Midget Cottontails are back in action again, starting their season with a bang by winning the Kanata Invitational tournament in mid-December.

This tournament featured a four-team round-robin format with the two top teams meeting again for the gold medal.

In their first game the girls made short work of Gloucester, beating them 61-25. Game two against a stubborn Goulbourn team was tight until the girls finally woke up (as a coach, I hate those early-morning games) and got their legs working to cruise to a 38-18 victory.

The final game in the round robin was against a young and inexperienced Kanata squad that could not

handle the Cottontails' full-court press as the girls earned their way into the gold-medal game with an easy 55-21 victory and a sweep of their three games.

The gold-medal game pitted the team against Goulbourn once more. They came out flying while the Cottontail players were very complacent, having had too easy a time to this point.

Midway through the first quarter Goulbourn had built up a 12-2 lead.

Slowly but surely the girls whittled away at the point spread and by half time managed to finally take the lead 20-19.

In the third quarter the defence took over, limiting Goulbourn to three points while the offence hit for 18. This outburst put the game

out of reach with a final score of 48-34 in favour of the Cottontails.

League play

In league play the Cottontails traveled to Smiths Falls to play Brockville and the host Smiths Falls team. Brockville always fields a very competitive team which would be the team's first real test of this new season.

The game started slowly with neither team able to hit their first few shots. The Cottontails' press began to show kinks in the Brockville attack as it started to force many turnovers.

These turnovers led to some easy baskets that got the girls' confidence up. By half time the girls had surged to a 40-26 lead.

The second half was more

wide-open basketball but Brockville could not cut into the lead with the game ending in a well-deserved 68-52 win for the Cottontails.

Smiths Falls provided the opposition in game two and played a very deliberate slow-down style of basketball. This resulted in a very low-scoring first half with the Cottontails holding on to a slim 22-18 lead.

Some adjustments to the defence and playing with a lot more enthusiasm saw the flood gates open in the second half as Smiths Falls could not keep up. The team held the opposition to four second-half points while scoring 38 cruising to a 60-22 victory.

This year's team has the potential of being one of the strongest ever with a com-

bination of speed and size coupled with excellent ball-handling and good shooting skills. The team members include: Bliss Edwards, Natanyah Ganz, Kelly Lewis, Casey O'Brien, Shannon O'Brien, Amy O'Keefe, Wanda Praamsma, Samantha Pokrywa, Nicky Ramien, Trina Rytwinski, Kim Watters and Christy Wilson.

The weekend of Jan. 10-12 sees the girls off to Kingston to play in the Prime Time Fighting Irish tournament. On Jan. 18, the Cottontails will host Gananoque and Cornwall in league play at Notre Dame Catholic High School in Carleton Place.

The first game starts at 10 a.m. and the team encourages anyone who enjoys good basketball to come out and watch.

Watch the rock

Christine Goodman throws the rock as fellow Almonte curlers Wanda McKinnon and Heather Koslerv wait to see if they need to sweep. The team, skipped by Jaye Carlson, played in the Stanley-Gauthier bonspiel in Almonte for novice female curlers.



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